

NOVAHR

HR and Payroll, Built for South African Business

Quick Start Guide

Get up and running in 15 minutes

hello@novahr.co.za | novahr-five.vercel.app

NovaHR Quick Start Guide

Audience: New HR Administrators **Time required:** About 30 minutes **Goal:** From empty account to your first calculated payslip.

Before You Start

NovaHR

Dashboard

Employees

Payroll

Compliance

Leave

Deductions

Reports

Tenants

Start here

Billing

Settings

LD

Lerato Dlamini

HR Administrator

Dashboard

Good morning, **Lerato**

Here's what's happening at NovaTech Solutions today, 11 July 2026.

Team members

16

3 onboarding - 1 on leave

Monthly payroll

R1.3M

Gross, current roster

Pending leave requests

2

Awaiting your review

Next payroll run

25 Sept 2026

15 employees

Payroll trend

Gross vs. net pay over the last 8 months

Y-axis: R 0, 350.0K, 700.0K, 1.1M, 1.4M. X-axis: Jan, Feb, Mar, Apr, May, Jun, Jul, Aug. Legend: Gross (blue), Net (green).

Department breakdown

Headcount across 8 departments

Engineering	31%	Product	13%
Sales	13%	Finance	13%
Customer Success	13%	Design	6%
Marketing	6%	People & Culture	6%

Recent activity

Latest updates across your workspace

Aisha Patel

annual leave request was approved

03 Jul 2026

AP

Johan Pretorius

family responsibility leave request was rejected

03 Jul 2026

JP

Aisha Patel

requested 21 days of annual leave

03 Jul 2026

AP

Wandile Tester

started onboarding as Actuarial Applications Developer

03 Jul 2026

WT

Wandile Mtshwene

employment terminated (resignation)

03 Jul 2026

WM

Wandile Mtshwene

started onboarding as Actuarial Applications Developer

03 Jul 2026

WM

NovaTech Solutions HR

processed payroll for August 2026

03 Jul 2026

NH

Wandile Mtshwene

started onboarding as Actuarial Applications Developer

03 Jul 2026

WM

September 2026 payroll

Scheduled run

Pay date: 25 September 2026

Employees: 16

Projected gross: R1,289,166.68

Go to payroll →

Leave approvals

2 requests need your review

Buhle Khumalo

Annual leave - 5 days

22 Jun 2026 to 26 Jun 2026

✓

✗

Tumi Sithole

Unpaid leave - 3 days

01 Jul 2026 to 03 Jul 2026

✓

✗

Add employee

Start onboarding a new hire

Run payroll

Process the next pay run

Review leave

Approve or decline requests

View reports

Payroll and workforce insights

Your NovaHR dashboard

Have these at hand:

- Company details: registered name, address, PAYE / UIF / SDL reference numbers (from SARS and the Department of Employment and Labour);
- For each employee: full name, SA ID number, income tax number, date of birth, bank details, salary and allowances, pension and medical aid details, start date, leave balances.

Step 1: Set Up Your Company (5 min)

1. Log in and open **Settings, Company**.
2. Complete the company profile: legal name, address, contact details.
3. Open **Settings, Payroll** and capture your PAYE, UIF, and SDL reference numbers, and confirm whether your company is SDL-liable (annual payroll above R500,000).
4. Set your pay day and pay frequency.

Step 2: Create Structure (5 min)

NovaHR Employees

Add employee
Capture the details needed to add a new team member and kick off their onboarding checklist.

1 Personal details
Basic and contact information

2 Role & employment
Position, department and reporting

3 Compensation
Salary, allowances and banking

4 Review & confirm
Check details before creating

Basic information

1 First name
e.g. Thandiwe

2 Last name
e.g. Nkosi

Preferred name (optional)
e.g. Thandi

ID number
e.g. 9001015009087

Email address
e.g. john.smith@company.co.za

Phone number
e.g. 076 123 4567

Tax number (optional)
e.g. 9123456789

Residential address
e.g. 12 Long Street, Cape Town, 8001

Emergency contact

Full name
e.g. Nomsa Nkosi

Relationship
e.g. Spouse

Phone number
e.g. 082 345 6789

← Back Continue →

Adding a new employee: fill in the highlighted fields

1. **Departments:** add your departments (e.g. Operations, Sales, Admin).
2. **Positions:** add job titles and link them to departments.

Step 3: Add Employees (10 min)

1. Open **Employees, Add Employee**.
2. Capture personal details (ID number, date of birth, contact details), employment details (position, department, start date), and pay details (salary, allowances, pension %, medical aid dependants, bank account).
3. Set opening leave balances so accruals start from the right point.
4. Repeat for each employee. Double-check dates of birth (they drive tax rebates) and medical dependants (they drive tax credits).

Step 4: Invite Users (3 min)

NovaHR Leave

Review requests, track balances and manage leave policies.

Pending requests 2
Awaiting review

On leave today 2
Out of 17 employees

Approved this period 4
34 days total

Declined this period 2
Requests rejected

Requests Calendar Balances Policies Public holidays

All statuses All types

Employee	Type	Dates	Days	Reason	Doc	Status	Actions
Aisha Patel Engineering	Annual leave	03 Jul 2026 to 31 Jul 2026	21	awdawdawdw		Approved	Lerato Dlamini
Aisha Patel Engineering	Sick leave	10 Jun 2026 to 11 Jun 2026	2	Flu, doctor's note attached.		Approved	Thabo Nkosi
Johan Pretorius Engineering	Family responsibility leave	15 Jun 2026 to 15 Jun 2026	1	School orientation day for my ...		Rejected	Lerato Dlamini
Buhle Khumalo Sales	Annual leave	22 Jun 2026 to 26 Jun 2026	5	Family event in Durban, flights ...		Pending	✓ ✕
Tumi Sithole Finance	Unpaid leave	01 Jul 2026 to 03 Jul 2026	3	Extended family visiting from o...		Pending	✓ ✕
Craig Adams Sales	Annual leave	10 Jul 2026 to 17 Jul 2026	6	Annual family holiday to the Ga...		Approved	Lerato Dlamini
Naledi Mahlangu Engineering	Annual leave	09 Jun 2026 to 13 Jun 2026	5	Family vacation to Mauritius, b...		Approved	Lerato Dlamini
Werner Botha Finance	Annual leave	20 May 2026 to 22 May 2026	3	Short break before month end.		Rejected	Lerato Dlamini

Leave management: submit and approve requests

1. Open **Settings, Users** and invite your employees and managers by email.
2. Assign roles: Employee (self-service), Manager (team approvals), HR Admin (full access), Executive (dashboards).
3. Invitees receive an email link to set their own password.

Step 5: Run a Test Payroll (5 min)

The screenshot displays the NovaHR Payroll dashboard. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, Employees, Payroll (selected), Compliance, Leave, Deductions, Reports, Tenants, Billing, and Settings. The main content area is titled 'Payroll' and includes a sub-header 'Review pay runs, track totals and publish payslips to your team.' Below this, a notification states 'August 2026 payroll is ready to pay' for 15 employees with a net pay of R 846,877.98, due on 25 August 2026, with a 'Submit payroll to Netcash' button. A summary row shows: Next pay date (25 Sept 2026), Projected gross (R1.3M), Projected net (R817.9K), and Year to date (R5.7M). Below this is a 'Netcash account' section with a 'Load' button. The 'September 2026 payroll' section is marked 'Scheduled' and shows an upcoming run for 16 eligible employees with a projected gross of R1,289,166.68, with a 'Start payroll run' button. At the bottom, a 'Payroll history' table shows the August 2026 run as 'Completed'.

Period	Pay date	Status	Employees	Gross	Net
August 2026	25 Aug 2026	Completed	15	R 1,347,500.01	R 846,877.98

Starting a payroll run

1. Open **Payroll, New Run** and select the current period.
2. Review each employee's calculated payslip: gross, PAYE, UIF, deductions, net.
3. Cross-check one payslip against your previous payroll or the SARS calculator.
4. **Do not publish yet** if you are still verifying: published payslips are visible to employees.

Step 6: Go Live

1. Work through the Onboarding Guide's go-live checklist (parallel run recommended for your first month);
2. Approve and publish the run; employees are notified and can download payslip PDFs;
3. Use **Reports** for your EMP201 figures (due to SARS by the 7th of next month).

Where to Get Help

- Knowledge base and manuals: in-app Help;
- Email: hello@novahr.co.za (include your company name and a screenshot);
- Full guides: Administrator Manual, Payroll Setup Guide, FAQ.